

(30)

Redfurythings

by: Vixyy Fox

(#Twelve Manny)

I prefer being in my human form. That's just me. Ten and Eleven, that is, Scott and Fred are Foxes. I follow after them in the numbered scheme of things, being Number Twelve, but I'm a Wolf... well, sort of a Wolf. I think I'm an oddball (no reflection on the big round thing Wire's been playing with) because, I like being in human form.

This morning, Fred and Scott followed me when I went into the woods with my camp shovel. Yeah, I complained to them about 'no privacy' when I caught them trying to prank me. They were changed to their feral Fox forms, and hiding in the bushes pretending like they belonged there. In between doing what I was doing, I picked up a small rock and managed to bean Fred. That sent him scurrying away right enough, but then another Fox stands up from the bushes on two legs, and begins yelling at me in Chincutella. The dressing down lasted a good half a minute before she darted away. I saw that 'it' was a female, if only briefly, but then a voice right behind me said, 'What the F***?'

I spun around, raising my camp shovel ready to defend myself, and found Scott standing there in his werefox form. He really had a puzzled look on his face.

"Did you understand anything of what she said?" I asked, lowering my shovel.

"Some of it. I think she was telling you to leave her chosen mate alone... oh... and she called you a big bully human."

"Seems no one really liked humans much," I muttered. Then we both yelled for Fred, but there wasn't any answer.

"I didn't hit him hard enough to hurt him," I told Scott softly, as I buckled my pants, and we began scouting the underbrush.

Scott, his nose being much better than mine, pointed at some tracks, and then chuckled.

"Whoever 'she' is, she's following Fred, and I have a strong suspicion she wants to jump his bones."

"Rescue?" I asked him.

"Yeahhh... I think we better. With his luck, she'll have rabies or something."

Figuring there wasn't any time to spare, we took off after the tracks and the scent. Now, having changed into my Wolf form, my nose was much sharper, and I had no problem tracking them down. This didn't take too long actually. We came to what appeared to be an old rain water conduit. It was pretty large, and the tracks, scent, and whatever else it was I was following disappeared into the thing.

Standing on one side of the conduit, with Scott on the other, I yelled into the darkness. “Fred! Are you alright?”

“I think so.”

“What do you mean ‘you think so’!” Scott yelled at him. “Get your ass out here before I come in and drag you out by the foot.”

“I can’t,” he yelled back. This was followed by a spat of hissing Chincutella, and Fred letting out with a loud ‘OW’.

“What’s the matter?” I yelled into the hole.

“She bit me on the ear!”

“She tagged him,” said a funny sounding voice, which made us jump. That odd looking robot friend of Mr. Brown was sitting a few feet back from the hole, its fake Wolf head looking hideously funny. It must have noticed my expression, because it quickly told me, I can roll very quietly when I have to.” It then said very loudly, “Scott!”

“I’m Scott,” the Fox standing next to me told the ballman. “The one in the hole is Fred.”

“Oh... ‘in the hole’... is that meant as a joke? Ha Ha... that’s funny.”

By now I was really freaking out. “I don’t get it, Chink... your name is Chink, isn’t it?”

“That’s my nick name, given to me by Farmer Brown. My real name is actually long, and very difficult to pronounce, given all the ones and zeros and...”

“Chink,” I interrupted, “What did you mean, she tagged him?”

“When the female Redfurything mates, she bites the male on the ear to mark him as belonging to her.”

“You mean Fox?” I asked.

“In WCCS you say ‘fox’. Our forces called them ‘Redfurythings’. Our side developed them as helpers. They did things like carry supplies, tend to the wounded, dig defensive emplacements, but they were not very good helpers. Most of them ran away.”

“Why was that?” Scott asked.

“I always thought they were smarter than us, but we were robots, and they were carbon life forms. As such, they were very temperamental, and when the females went into heat they did what they wanted. There were many fights... snarling screaming tooth and claw... don’t interfere, because they will take your finger off if you are another carbon life form... very mean creatures.”

Leaning back over the hole, Scott then yelled, “Fred! You need to get your butt out here. You have no idea what you’re dealing with.”

“I would, but I’m stuck.”

“What do you mean stuck? Wiggle around and snake your way back out, it’s a large hole... and keep your fingers away from her snout. She’ll bite them off.”

“May I offer some advice?” Chink asked them.

“If it will help, I’m all ears,” I told him, and he actually laughed.

“Yes, you are all ears being in Wolf form.”

“Very funny,” I growled, “Now what’s your advice?”

“Your comrade is not stuck in the tunnel. These conduits are quite roomy. He is stuck in his new mate.”

“What do you mean stuck in his new mate?” Scott asked.

I have to admit I had more than a few red flags waving in my mind with an emergency voice saying, ‘DO NOT GO THERE... DO NOT GO THERE!’

“During mating, the female Redfurything’s body clamps down like the fist of Titan, gripping the male’s appendage sometimes to the point of cutting off circulation. This has been known to injure his member, but seldom is that permanent or to the point of true damage. Her swelling never lasts more than a day, so there is hope your comrade will not be badly damaged. If he can, he should fall asleep.”

“It hurts...” Fred howled from within the tunnel. “Get me out of here!”

“Did he say, ‘here’ or ‘her’?” I asked Scott with a snicker.

“Knot funny,” the Fox snickered back, and then we were both laughing, though the one in the drainage conduit was not amused, and said so loudly.

“May I make a suggestion?” the big ball robot with the fake Wolf’s head asked.

I made a mistake in looking at the face, and broke out laughing all over again.

“Fred,” Chink called out, “You need to relax. Do not struggle. Softly tell her your name, and then ask for hers. When she tells you, bite her on the same ear she bit on you. Do not fake it... you have to bite hard. When it bleeds be sure to lick it, then she will lick your ear.”

There were some words between the pair in the conduit, and then a very loud snarl/scream from the female. Right after that Fred let go with his own scream.

“Well that’s a plus,” Chink quipped, and I had a suspicion he was smiling. “Her name is Darga Vermona. The word ‘Darga’ means ‘Chief’ in her language... which is my language too, but you knew that.”

“What do we do?” Scott whispered to me.

“You stay here, and I’ll go get the commander.”

“WHAT ABOUT ME?!” Fred yelled at us.

“Congratulations on your mating!” Chink yelled back. “Have you considered where you might go for your honeymoon?”

He then laughed so hard, he rolled over.

(Nanna)

There was a commotion of some sort just outside the camp. Young Manny came running into the camp looking for Adam. I knew there was a problem, because he was in Wolf form and he prefers human form, so I watched. As I watched, I called to Mr. Brown, and asked that he would meet with me when the camp had less people in it.

“We got us a situation my love,” he told me over the com. “When I find out the details, I’ll let you know, but it sounds like we’re having another mating, but of the Fox type.”

“That will keep,” I countered. “Encourage as many of everybody to go and see what the fuss is. That way, when we talk, it will be somewhat more private.”

“It’s that critical, is it?”

“Maybe.”

“I’ll do it. Be there as quick as possible.”

He was good to his word, and a few minutes later he was telling me what was going on. Apparently Chink filled him in, and it really was pretty funny. I do have to admit I was just a bit jealous.

“It’s about Molly,” I told him.

“I figured it might be,” he replied.

“You did?”

“Yeah, she’s a true wild card. She comes and goes as she pleases, and she’s kinda hard to track since you can’t see her. Can you block her?”

“She’s never tried to push herself on me, and the only time she’s been in my mind, Hana was holding my hand.”

“What does she look like?”

“My memory always pulls up that poor little pup who was taken away. In my mind, when she’s there, I don’t see her at all... she’s just a voice.”

“I suggest we take her under advisement,” he told me.

“What do you mean?”

“So far she hasn’t done anything wrong. In fact, in the case of the Hunter, she was very useful. I was told that, though Hana was holding on to the outside, she was already inside keeping it from hitting the destruct button. That was without Hana’s help. If she wanted to end everything right quick, that would have been the moment to do it.”

“Perhaps that would have ended things for her too?”

“Maybe... but just maybe. Unless you’re a nut job, you’ll always have a way out.”

He leaned forward, placing his face against mine. “I know there’s a fight coming. Big battle or small, it’s still coming and a lot of our friends are going to die. I almost got it in that last fight, but I didn’t say anything, because I didn’t want you to worry.”

“Thank you.”

We heard singing coming from the direction everyone had gone in. It was a rhythmic chant with associated hand clapping. Brown snorted over the com, and I asked him what was happening.

“It’s a copulation chant, probably Wolf Song. Whatever’s going on, it’s got to be a dilly. Let’s go see who the lucky couple is this time. No more talk of Molly,” he told me, “That stays between us and only as a possible concern.”

“Agreed.”

And so we went to the chanting, and though I tried not to laugh, I did... especially when seeing the silly wolf head on that big round robot. I asked Brown to introduce me, and I found Chink to be, unusual, yes, but so very polite, and caring. He explained the Redfurythings to me, and that made me laugh even more. He does have a way with words.